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Part 1: Architecture

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Foreword

This Technical Specification (TS) has been produced by ETSI Technical Committee Electronic Signatures and Infrastructures (ESI).

The present document is part 1 of a multi-part deliverable covering Registered Electronic Mail (REM), as identified below:

Part 1: "Architecture";

Part 2: "Data requirements, Formats and Signatures for REM";

Part 3: "Information Security Policy Requirements for REM Management Domains";

Part 4: "REM-MD Conformance Profiles";

Part 5: "REM-MD Interoperability Profiles";

Part 6: "Interoperability Profiles":

Sub-part 1: "REM-MD UPU PReM Interoperability Profile";

Sub-part 2: "REM-MD BUSDOX Interoperability Profile";

Sub-part 3: "REM-MD SOAP Binding Profile".

Introduction

Business and administrative relationships among companies, public administrations and private citizens, are the more and more implemented electronically. Trust is becoming essential for their success and continued development of electronic services. It is therefore important that any entity using electronic services have suitable security controls and mechanisms in place to protect their transactions and to ensure trust and confidence with their partners.

Electronic mail is a major tool for electronic business and administration. Additional security services are necessary for e-mail to be trusted. At the time of writing the present document, in some European Union Member States (Italy, Belgium, etc.) regulation(s) and application(s) are being developed**, if not already in place,** on mails transmitted by electronic means providing origin authentication and proof of delivery. A range of Registered E-Mail ("REM") services is already established and their number is set to grow significantly over the next few years. Without the definition of common standards there will be no consistency in the services provided, making it difficult for users to compare them. Under these circumstances, users might be prevented from easily changing to alternative providers, damaging free competition. Lack of standardization might also affect interoperability between REM based systems implemented based on different models. The present document is to ensure a consistent form of service across Europe, especially with regard to the form of evidence provided, in order to maximize interoperability even between e-mail domains governed by different policy rules.

In order to move towards the general recognition and readability of evidence provided by registered e-mail services, it is necessary to specify technical formats, as well as procedures and practices for handling REM, and the ways the electronic signatures are applied to it. In this respect, the electronic signature is an important security component to protect the information and to provide trust in electronic business. It is to be noted that a simple "electronic signature" would be insufficient to provide the required trust to an information exchange. Therefore the present document assumes the usage of at least an Advanced Electronic Signature, with the meaning of article 2(2) of EU Directive 1999/93/EC [i.1], issued with a Secure Signature Creation Device, with the meaning of article 2(6) of the same Directive.

The scope of each part is summarised below.

TS 102 640-1 (the present document) "Architecture" provides an overall view of the REM, addressing all aspects:

- Logical model, namely: Components, Styles of Operation, Roles within a REM-MD, REM-MDs grouping in administrative domains named REM Policy Domains.
- Interfaces between the involved entities.
- Events of shipment, transmission, delivery or download of messages concerning the REM environment and Evidence types generated by REM-MDs against these events.
- Layering model and trust building among REM Management Domains, within the same or a different REM Policy Domain, or to non REM Systems.

TS 102 640-2 [1] provides:

- Rules for building a REM-MD Envelope and, consequently, a REM Dispatch or a REM-MD Message.
- Syntax and semantics of REM-MD Evidence to be produced by a REM Management Domain.
- Rules on the signature to be applied within REM-MD Envelopes.
- Specifications on TSL to be issued for mutual recognition of REM-MDs.

TS 102 640-3 [i.6] specifies requirements on the Registered E-Mail Management Domain (REM-MD) Information Security Management System based on per ISO/IEC 27001 [i.9].

Provisions, additional to ISO/IEC 27001 [i.9] controls, are also specified that address:

- REM-MD practices statement.
- REM Interconnection Statement.
- REM Sender/REM Recipient Authentication.
- Electronic signature related issues relevant to the REM.
- measures related to records retention and destruction.

TS 102 640-4 [i.7] "REM-MD Conformance Profiles" specifies two levels of conformance requirements:

- Basic Conformance Profile that indicates the minimum set of mandatory requirements that are to be met by any REM-MD that claims to be conformant with TS 102 640-1 (the present document), TS 102 640-2 [1] and TS 102 640-3 [i.6]; and
- Advanced Conformance Profile that includes a set of voluntary additional requirements to the Basic Conformance Profile for enhanced security and advanced evidential services.

TS 102 640-5 [i.8] "REM-MD Interoperability Profiles" addresses the followings aspects:

- Defines a profile for interoperability among REM-MDs based on SMTP relay protocol.
- Profiles the implementation of TS 102 640 based systems, addressing issues relating to authentication, authenticity and integrity of the information to achieve interoperability between such systems.
- Covers all the options to profile REM-MD for both styles of operation: S&N and S&F.

TS 102 640-6-1 [i.11] "REM-MD UPU PReM interoperability Profile" provides:

- Requirements for achieving interoperability between the Registered Electronic Mail systems that are compliant with parts 1 (the present document) to 2 [1] of TS 102 640 and systems that are compliant with UPU S52-1 UPU Postal Registered electronic Mail functional specification (PReM henceforth)

- All the necessary mappings between the two specifications taking into account also the objective to maintain and preserve the positive features present in both the realities as pursued in the present document.

TS 102 640-6-2 [i.12] "REM-MD BUSDOX Interoperability Profile" specifies:

- Requirements for achieving interoperability between the Registered Electronic Mail systems compliant with TS 102 640 and systems that are compliant with "Business Document Exchange Network service metadata and transport" specification.

- Define all the necessary mappings between the two specifications.

TS 102 640-6-3 [i.13] "REM-MD SOAP Binding Profile" provides:

- Rules for building a REM-MD Envelope (and, consequently, a REM Dispatch or a REM-MD Message) as well defined XML Information Sets (Infoset).

- Rules for secure transport of the above REM-MD XML Infosets using SOAP, combined with appropriate bricks of the Web Services stack (profiling of WS-Addressing and WS-Security).

1 Scope

The basic purpose of Registered E-Mail service is to provide users, in addition to the usual services supplied by the ordinary e-mail service providers, with a set of Evidence suitable to uphold assertions of acceptance (i.e. of "shipment"), of delivery/non delivery, of retrieval, etc. of e-mails sent/delivered through such service.

The present document specifies an architectural structure of REM, more specifically:

a) describes a logical model for REM including the most relevant REM architectural elements and how they relate to each other (REM-MD Messages, REM Sender, REM Recipient, etc.) and the following styles of operation:

   1) "Store and Forward" (S&F henceforth), whereREM Objects are directly forwarded from REM-MDs to the REM Recipient; and

   2) "Store and Notify" (S&N henceforth) where the REM Recipient is first notified of that a REM Object is stored and is provided with a reference to the location where the REM Object can be downloaded.

b) describes how REM components interact using external interfaces to REM users, and interfaces to other REM implementations;

c) describes a policy domain environment; and

d) specifies a list of different types of events and the REM-MD Evidence types that represent them.

Evidential services are deemed to comply with legal, regulatory or contractual requirements to provide legal validity and enforceability under domestic or international law.

The present document does not provide specification for interactions among architectural elements internal to the REM-MD. Although interfaces to physical mail could exist, the present document does not provide standardized interfaces to physical mail.

The structure of the present document is as follows:

- clause 2 contains the list of normative and informative references;
- clause 3 includes definitions of the relevant concepts to the present document and abbreviations;
- clause 4 contains the logical model for REM provision;
- clause 5 specifies REM interfaces;
- clause 6 provides a list of different types of events and REM-MD Evidence; and
- clause 7 deals with the implementation of a TSL based mechanism for allowing mutual trust of REM-MDs.

2 References

References are either specific (identified by date of publication and/or edition number or version number) or non-specific. For specific references, only the cited version applies. For non-specific references, the latest version of the reference document (including any amendments) applies.

Referenced documents which are not found to be publicly available in the expected location might be found at http://docbox.etsi.org/Reference.

NOTE: While any hyperlinks included in this clause were valid at the time of publication, ETSI cannot guarantee their long term validity.

2.1 Normative references

The following referenced documents are necessary for the application of the present document.

[1] ETSI TS 102 640-2: "Electronic Signatures and Infrastructures (ESI); Registered Electronic Mail (REM); Part 2: Data requirements, Formats and Signatures for REM".

2.2 Informative references

The following referenced documents are not necessary for the application of the present document but they assist the user with regard to a particular subject area.

[i.1] Directive 1999/93/EC of the European Parliament and of the Council of 13 December 1999 on a Community framework for electronic signatures.

[i.2] Void.

[i.3] ETSI TS 102 023: "Electronic Signatures and Infrastructures (ESI); Policy requirements for time-stamping authorities".

[i.4] IETF RFC 3161 (2001):"Internet X.509 Public Key Infrastructure Time-Stamp Protocol (TSP)".

[i.5] IETF RFC 1305 (1992): "Network Time Protocol (Version 3) Specification, Implementation and Analysis".

[i.6] ETSI TS 102 640-3: "Electronic Signatures and Infrastructures (ESI); Registered Electronic Mail (REM); Part 3: Information Security Policy Requirements for REM Management Domains".

[i.7] ETSI TS 102 640-4: "Electronic Signatures and Infrastructures (ESI); Registered Electronic Mail (REM); Part 4: REM-MD Conformance Profiles".

[i.8] ETSI TS 102 640-5: "Electronic Signatures and Infrastructures (ESI); Registered Electronic Mail (REM); Part 5: REM-MD Interoperability Profiles".

[i.9] ISO/IEC 27001:2005: "Information technology - Security techniques - Information security management systems - Requirements".

[i.10] ETSI TS 102 231: "Electronic Signatures and Infrastructures (ESI); Provision of harmonized Trust-service status information".

[i.11] ETSI TS 102 640-6-1: "Electronic Signatures and Infrastructures (ESI); Registered Electronic Mail (REM); Part 6: Interoperability Profiles; Sub-part 1: REM-MD UPU PReM Interoperability Profile".

[i.12] ETSI TS 102 640-6-2: "Electronic Signatures and Infrastructures (ESI); Registered Electronic Mail (REM); Part 6: Interoperability Profiles; Sub-part 2: REM-MD BUSDOX Interoperability Profile".

[i.13] ETSI TS 102 640-6-3: "Electronic Signatures and Infrastructures (ESI); Registered Electronic Mail (REM); Part 6: Interoperability Profiles; Sub-part 3: REM-MD SOAP Binding Profile".

[i.14] ETSI TS 101 733 (V1.5.1): "Electronic Signatures and Infrastructures (ESI); CMS Advanced Electronic Signatures (CAdES)".

[i.15] ETSI TS 101 903 (V1.2.2): "Electronic Signatures and Infrastructures (ESI); XML Advanced Electronic Signatures (XAdES)".

3 Definitions and abbreviations

3.1 Definitions

For the purposes of the present document, the following terms and definitions apply:

certification authority: authority trusted by one or more users to create and assign public-key certificates

information security policy: statement of policy which provides management direction and support for information security in accordance with business requirements and relevant laws and regulations

long term storage: role that supports the integrity of data and the authenticity of a signature over the period required to store data for evidential purposes that can be used by the Message Archive

message archive: optional role that supports storage of REM Objects and REM-MD Evidence, as required for later use for evidential or any other legally admitted purposes, at the relevant REM-MD for an indefinite or definite time period, to be accessed once or many times by one or more entities

original message: e-mail message generated by the Sender's User Agent or under the Sender's technical/legal responsibility (i.e. outside of the REM-MD), which may be signed by the Sender

NOTE: It has to be conveyed to the REM Recipient either by value (in the Store & Forward Style of operations) or by reference (in the Store & Notify Style of operations).

Registered E-Mail (REM): enhanced form of mail transmitted by electronic means (e-mail) which provides evidence relating to the handling of an e-mail including proof of submission and delivery

REM dispatch: REM-MD Envelope containing the Original Message and related REM-MD Evidence

REM Management Domain (REM-MD): set of technical and physical components, personnel, policies and processes that provide REM services

NOTE: A REM-MD is operated under the responsibility of a single management entity.

REM-MD envelope: signed structure generated by the REM MD which envelopes an Original message and/or REM-MD Evidence

REM-MD evidence: signed data created within a REM-MD, which proves that a certain event has occurred at a certain time

NOTE: It may be signed directly or indirectly by placing it within a REM-MD Envelope.

REM-MD Evidence Provider: role that issues REM-MD Evidence

REM-MD Evidence Verifier: role that supports the verification of REM-MD Evidence

REM-MD Message: message generated by the REM MD under the REM MD sole technical/legal responsibility (i.e. inside of the REM MD)

NOTE: It is to be signed by the entity legally responsible for the REM MD. It may be understood by the REM Recipient/REM Sender as a "receipt" or a "notification". A REM-MD Message carries an REM-MD Envelope containing REM-MD Evidence.

REM-MD Message Gateway: role that supports the transfer of REM objects to conventional e-mail (e.g. Internet) services and physical postal delivery services

REM Message Store: role that supports the storage of REM Objects. In other words the set of mailboxes of the users

REM-MD Message Transfer Agent: role that supports the transfer of REM Objects to REM Recipient's and REM Sender's REM Message Store either directly or via the **REM Object Relay Interface** into another REM-MD or via a REM-MD Message Gateway

REM-MD Repository: role that supports the storage of REM Objects, REM-MD Evidence and any other, which must be accessed by reference

REM-MD Repository Retrieval Interface: interface of REM-MD towards REM UA used in the Store and Notify Style of Operation by the REM Recipient for downloading REM Objects from REM-MD Repository

NOTE: It can also be used by REM Senders for downloading REM-MD Evidence.

REM-MD Sender Message Submission Interface: interface of REM-MD towards sender REM UA used by the REM Sender to submit Original Messages to his REM-MD, for them to be forwarded to the REM Recipients

REM-MD Sender/Recipient Message Store Retrieval Interface: interface of REM-MD towards REM UA used by REM Senders or REM Recipients to fetch REM Objects addressed to them

REM-MD Third Party Evidence Retrieval Interface: interface that supports REM-MD Evidence and REM Objects retrieval by users that are parties external to the usual message flow

REM Object: message object handled by a REM-MD. This is a REM-MD Message, REM-Dispatch or Original message

REM Objects Relay Interface: interface that supports REM objects relaying between disparate REM-MD

REM Policy: set of rules (e.g. legal, company policy or agreement) enforced for the provision of REM Services

REM Policy Domain: any domain where a common set of rules (e.g. legal, company policy or agreement) is enforced for the provision of REM services

NOTE: This domain may be a country, a Company, a group of Countries, etc., even a single REM-MD.

REM Policy Domain Authority: authority entitled to enforce the common set of rules in which the REM policy Domain consists

REM Recipient: physical or legal entity legally responsible for the mailbox to which the original message is addressed

REM Sender: physical or legal entity legally responsible for the mailbox from which the original message has been sent

REM Third Party: party authorized to access REM Objects and REM-MD Evidence for specific purposes

REM User Agent (REM-UA): entity by which REM Senders, REM Recipients participate in the exchange of REM Objects and Third Parties may access REM Objects

Signature Creation Server: server that supports the creation of digital signature against data (e.g. evidence)

Time-Stamping Authority: authority which issues time-stamp tokens (TS 102 023 [i.3])

Time-Stamp Token: data object that binds a representation of a datum to a particular time, thus establishing evidence that the datum existed before that time (TS 102 023 [i.3])

Throughout the present document a number of verbal forms are used, whose meaning is defined below.

- **Shall, shall not:** indicate requirements strictly to be followed in order to conform to the present document and from which no deviation is permitted.
- **Should, should not:** indicate that among several possibilities one is recommended as particularly suitable, without mentioning or excluding others, or that a certain course of action is preferred but not necessarily required, or that (in the negative form) a certain possibility or course of action is deprecated but not prohibited.
- **May, need not:** indicate a course of action permissible within the limits of the present document.

3.2 Abbreviations

For the purposes of the present document, the following abbreviations apply:

AdES	Advanced Electronic Signature
CA	Certification Authority
CAdES	CMS Advanced Electronic Signatures
CEN	Comité Européen de Normalization

NOTE: CEN was founded in 1961 by the national standards bodies in the European Economic Community and EFTA countries, that are contributing to the objectives of the European Union and European Economic Area with voluntary technical standards.

CMS	Cryptographic Message Syntax
CSP	Certification Service Providers
EUMS	EU Member States
MD-RI	Message and Evidence Relay Interface
NTP	Network Time Protocol
QC	Qualified Certificate
REM	Registered E-Mail
REM-MD	REM Management Domain
REM-PD	REM Policy Domain
RSRI	REM-MD Repository Retrieval Interface
REM-UA	REM User Agent
S&F	Store and Forward
S&N	Store and Notify
S/MIME	Secure/Multipurpose Internet Mail Extensions
S-MSI	REM-MD Sender Message Submission Interface
SMTP	Simple Mail Transfer Protocol
S/R-MSRI	REM-MD Sender/Recipient Message Store Retrieval Interface
TLS/SSL	Transport Layer Security/Secure Sockets Layer
TP-ERI	REM-MD Third Party Evidence Retrieval Interface
TrST	Trust Service Token
TSA	Time Stamping Authority
TSL	Trust-service Status List
TSP	Trust Services Provider
UPU	Universal Postal Union

NOTE: UPU is the primary forum for cooperation between postal-sector players and helps to ensure a truly universal network of up-to-date products and services.

URL	Uniform Resource Locator
XAdES	XML Advanced Electronic Signature

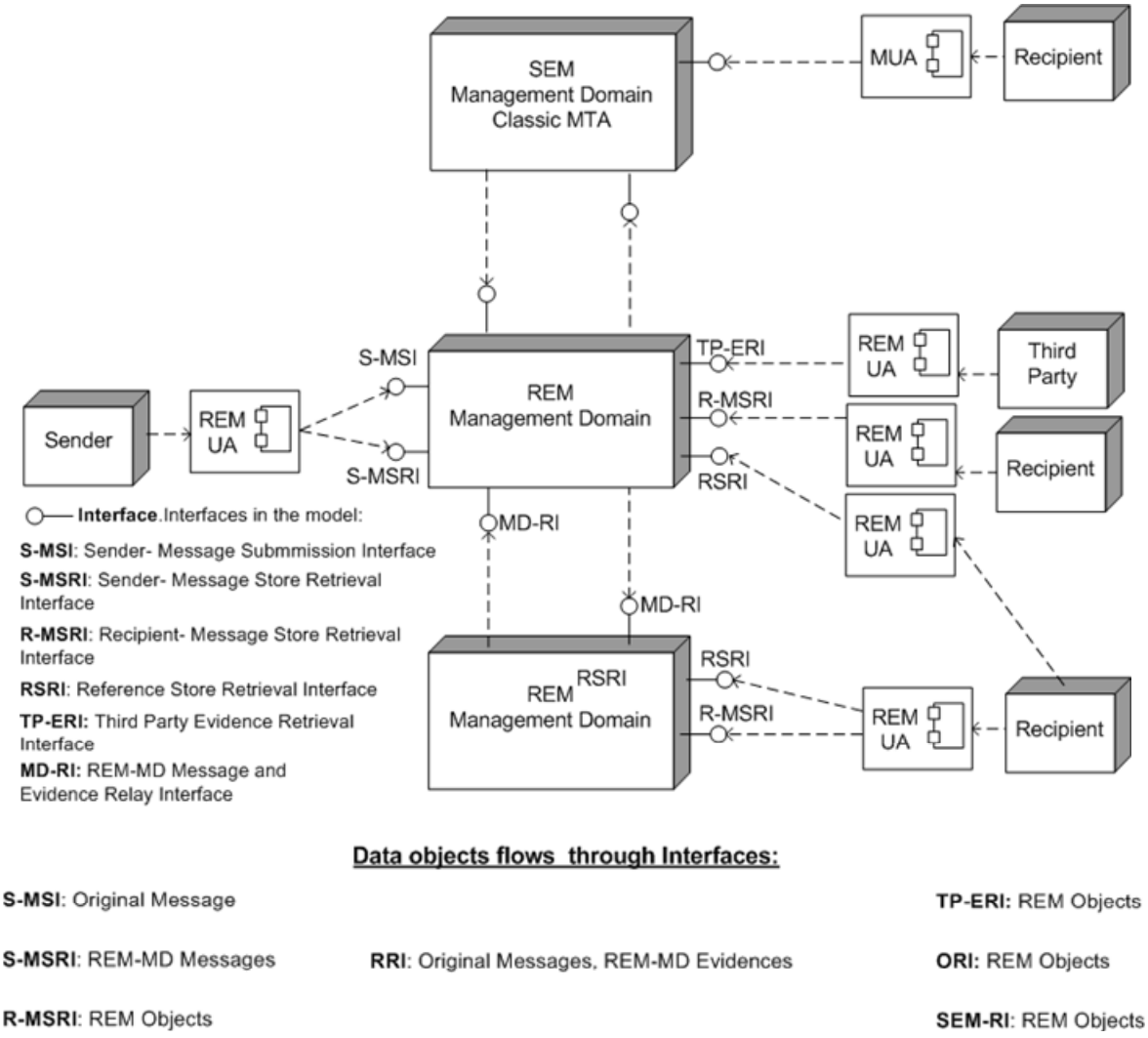
4 REM Logical Model

This clause specifies a logical model for REM. The model is aimed at supporting a range of REM implementations that **may** employ different styles of operation.

The model identifies those aspects of the REM that affect external interfaces to REM users, and interfaces to other REM implementations that **may** employ different styles of operation. Hence, the model is at a high level of abstraction and concentrates on those aspects of REM systems affecting external interfaces. The logical model is not related to any particular implementation.

4.1 REM Functional Viewpoint

The basic elements of the REM Logical Model from the functional viewpoint are illustrated in figure 1.



NOTE 1: Arrows indicate service user and provider relationship, their points do not necessarily represent the direction of the exchanged data flow. Circles indicate interfaces for exposing services. Dashed arrows describe use of services through the mentioned interfaces. They do not indicate information flows or direction.

NOTE 2: REM-MD RSRI interface is a mean that **may** be used also by not-subscriber REM Recipients.

Figure 1: REM Logical Model - Functional Viewpoint

In addition to transport services as provided by existing mailing systems, REM systems provide evidence services related to the submission, transmission (where applicable) and delivery of the REM Object. In particular, evidence services including some or all of evidence types mentioned in clause 6 **should** be provided to users (be they humans or systems).

The REM users are the REM Sender, the REM Recipient and any Third Party that could be, for instance, the user's organization, a judge in case of dispute, or a party nominated by the REM Sender or REM Recipient for receiving Evidence on their behalf. The same entity **may** act as both REM Sender and REM Recipient.

The REM Sender **shall** authenticate to the relevant REM-Management Domains (REM-MDs), but the choice of the authentication mechanism is left to the specific REM-MD. The REM Sender has access to the REM-MD services through a User Agent.

Delivery may require the REM Recipient's explicit acceptance of the new REM Object, This acceptance shall require authentication to the relevant REM-MD, but the choice of the authentication mechanism is left to the specific REM-MD.

REM implementation components are broken into REM User Agents (REM-UA) and REM-MDs.

The present document envisages scenarios where two REM-MDs might interoperate together via standard interfaces to provide the REM Object exchange. This is generally the case when the REM Sender and the REM Recipient are not in the same domain and therefore use different REM-MD. In this situation, the REM Object will have to be relayed between disparate REM-MDs.

REM-UA will be used by the REM Sender to send new REM Objects that will be forwarded with Evidence created by one relevant REM-MD, where applicable, as well as for retrieving Evidence generated by any REM-MD. The REM-UA interface to the REM-MD **may** be realized by two interfaces: one for sending REM Objects the other for receiving REM Objects. A REM UA **may** interface to more than one REM-MD. The form a User Agent can take is not further specified here. It could be an application installed on user's machine or, in some case, it could be provided as a service by the REM-MD itself (e.g. web mail).

These components interact using the interfaces described in clause 5, namely, REM-MD Sender Message Submission Interface, REM-MD Sender/Recipient Message Store Retrieval Interfaces, REM-MD Repository Retrieval Interface, REM Object Relay Interface, Non REM Relay Interface, REM-MD Third Party Evidence Retrieval Interface and REM-MD Repository Retrieval Interface.

4.2 REM Styles of Operation

Two types of REM styles of operation are described below: "Store and Forward" (S&F), and "Store and Notify" (S&N). They **may** interoperate in a different range of combinations, such as:

a) S&F to S&F, as described in clause 4.2.1;

b) S&N to S&F, where a reference to REM Object contained in a REM-MD Repository is relayed to the REM Recipient's REM-MD using a canonical S&F service;

c) S&N to S&N: in this operational scenario any reference to REM Object contained in a REM-MD Repository sent to a S&N REM-MD is relayed using a S&F service and it is handled, at REM Recipient's REM-MD's side by a S&F sub-component;

d) S&F to S&N, as described in figure 4.

4.2.1 REM Store and Forward Style of Operation

This clause describes the style of operation "Store and Forward" (S&F henceforth). Under this style of operation REM Objects are directly forwarded from REM-MDs to the REM Recipient, certain REM-MD Messages are directly forwarded from REM-MDs to the REM Sender of the Original Message, and certain REM-MD-Messages (see clause 6) are directly forwarded from REM-MDs to the REM Recipient of the Original Message.

Figure 2 shows two REM-MDs working under S&F style of operation interacting. A subscriber of the first REM-MD sends (this subscriber acts as REM Sender) a REM Object to a subscriber of the second REM-MD (this subscriber acts as REM Recipient of the Original Message). The figure shows an example of how the different REM Objects would flow among the different actors (REM-MDs and subscribers).

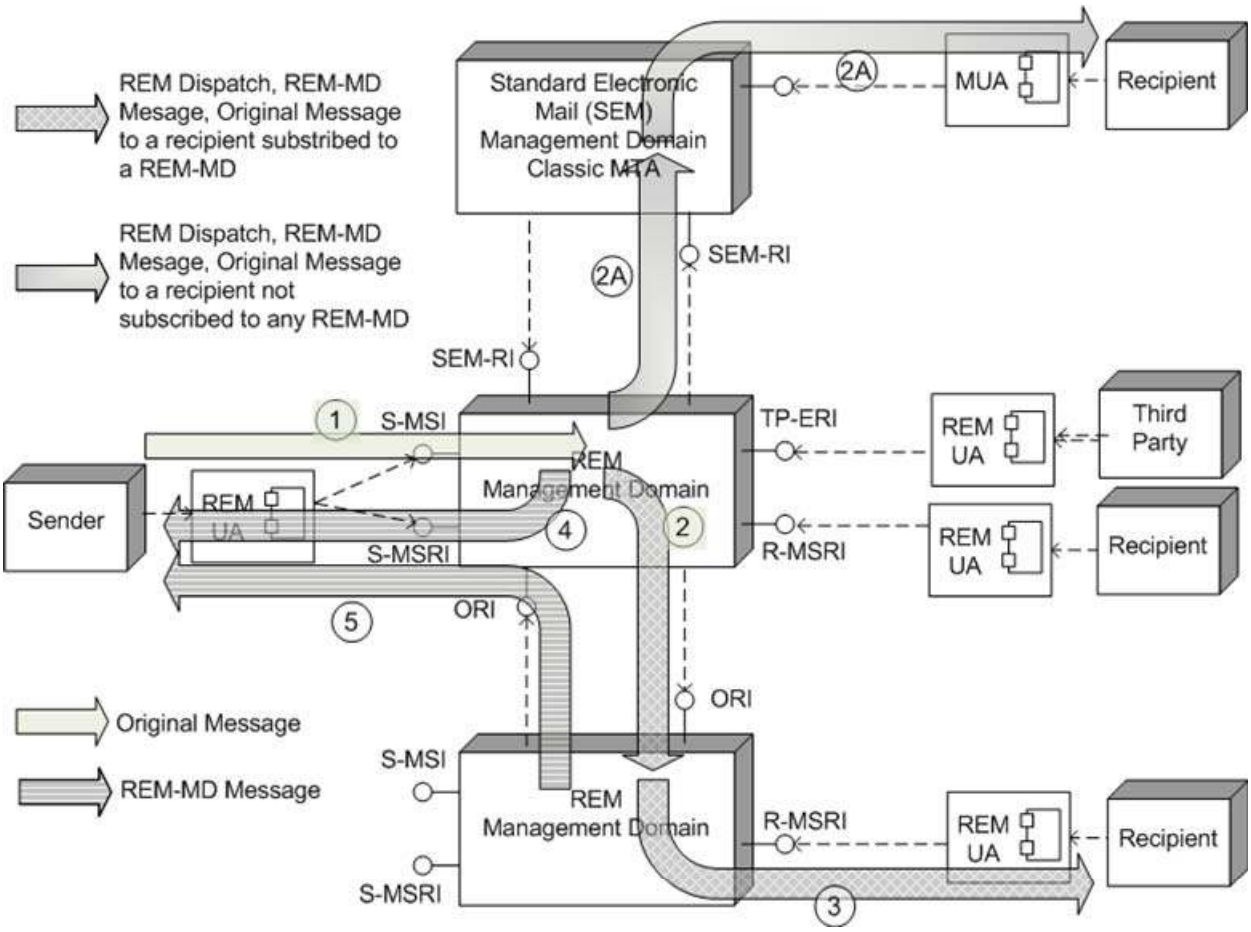


Figure 2: REM Store & Forward Logical Model - REM Sender and REM Recipient subscribers of different REM-MDs

In figure 2:

a) the REM Sender submits, through the REM-MD Sender Message Submission Interface, the Original Message addressed to the **REM Recipient** (flow 1 in figure 2);

b) the REM Sender's REM-MD **may** generate REM-MD Evidence for the REM Recipient. It **may** then create and forward a REM Dispatch including the Original Message and the aforementioned REM-MD Evidence, to the Recipient's REM-MD, Alternatively it **may** create a REM-MD Message containing only the REM-MD Evidence and separately forward this REM-MD Message and the Original Message to the Recipient's REM-MD through the **REM Object Relay Interface** (flow 2 in figure 2). Should the Recipient not be subscribed to any REM-MD, the Sender's REM-MD would forward the REM Object to the standard e-mail management domain through the Non-REM Relay Interface (SEM-RI in figure 2) (flow 2A in figure 2);

NOTE: Where a REM-MD Message is forwarded by one REM-MD to a non REM-MD it **may** contain no REM-MD Evidence.

c) the **REM Recipient**'s REM-MD receives any of the REM Objects aforementioned. It **may** generate new REM-MD Evidence. It **may** then deliver a REM Dispatch with the Original Message and any REM-MD Evidence generated so far, or separately forward the Original Message and REM-MD Messages with REM-MD Evidence, to the REM Recipient through the Recipient Message Store Retrieval Interface (flow 3 in figure 2);

d) in addition to the former actions and flows, a REM Sender's REM-MD **may** also generate specific REM-MD Evidence addressed to the REM Sender and deliver a REM-MD Message containing these REM-MD Evidence, through the REM-MD Sender Message Store Retrieval Interface (flow 4 in figure 2);

e) upon delivery in the REM Recipient's mailbox, or in case of non-delivery, the REM Recipient's REM-MD generates the corresponding REM-MD Evidence and sends a REM-MD Message containing such REM-MD Evidence addressed to the REM Sender. This REM-MD Evidence informs the REM Sender that the Original Message has been delivered/non delivered to the REM Recipient's mailbox (flow 5 in figure 2).

The present clause does not provide details on the sequence of events leading to the generation of REM-Evidence, nor establishes rules on when, how or by whom these REM-Evidence will be incorporated into a REM Object A sequence is detailed in annex A, although a different set of actions and flows **may** also be present in actual implementations.

REM-Evidence and formats for REM Objects flowing from one REM-MD to another using different technology are fully specified in TS 102 640-2 [1].

4.2.2 REM Store and Notify Style of Operation

This clause describes the style of operation "Store and Notify" (S&N henceforth). Under this style of operation an Original Message or a REM-MD Evidence is not directly forwarded to the REM Recipient.

The REM Sender's REM-MD stores the Original Message in its REM-MD Repository and creates a REM-MD Message for the REM Recipient that includes reference to REM-MD Repository. This reference to REM-MD Repository is made of a generic text, informing the REM Recipient that a REM Object intended for him/her is stored in the REM Sender's REM-MD's storage, and of a reference to the location where such REM Object can be downloaded from.

In this model, a REM-MD provides additional interfaces for REM Senders and/or REM Recipients to access Original Message and/or REM-MD Evidence.

The use of Store and Notify for the case where the REM Sender REM-MD supports store and notify is shown in figure 3.

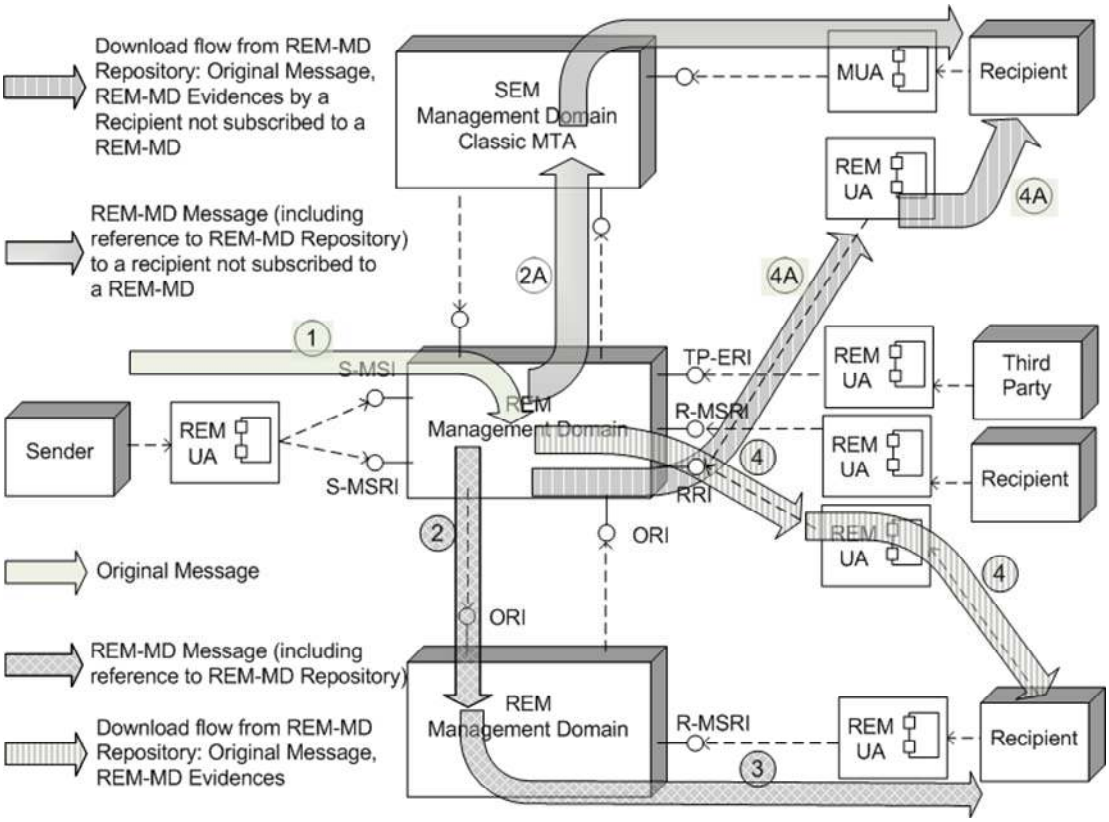


Figure 3: REM Store & Notify Logical Model - REM Sender's REM-MD creating the REM-MD Message

The flow and process steps as illustrated in figure 3 for this case are as follows:

a) the **REM Sender** submits the Original Message, addressed to the REM Recipient, through the REM-MD Sender Message Submission Interface (flow 1 in figure 3);

b) the REM Sender's REM-MD:

1) stores the REM Object in the REM-MD Repository;

2) creates a REM-MD Message that contains a reference to the REM Object within the REM-MD Repository;

3) adds any appropriate REM-MD Evidence to the aforementioned REM-MD Message or stores the REM-MD Evidence in the REM-MD Repository; and

4) forwards this REM-MD Message to the REM Recipient's REM-MD using the **REM Object Relay Interface** (flow 2 in figure 3). Should the Recipient not be subscribed to any REM-MD, the Sender's REM-MD would forward the REM-MD Message to the standard e-mail management domain through the Non-REM Relay Interface (SEM-RI in figure 3) (flow 2A in figure 3);

NOTE 1: This REM-MD Message could be forwarded to the REM Recipient via an ordinary e-mail provider, but in this case its delivery would be out of the REM control.

c) the REM Recipient's REM-MD forwards the REM-MD Message to the REM Recipient using the REM-MD Recipient Message Store Retrieval Interface (flow 3 in figure 3);

d) the REM Recipient downloads the REM Object (and the REM-MD Evidence if they are stored in the REM-MD Repository) from the REM Sender's REM-MD Repository through the REM-MD Repository Retrieval Interface. (flow 4 in figure 3). Should the Recipient be not subscribed to any REM-MD, still she would download the corresponding REM Object from the REM Sender's REM-MD Repository through the aforementioned interface (flow 4A in figure 3).

The use of store and notify for the case where the REM Recipients domain supports store and notify is shown in figure 4.

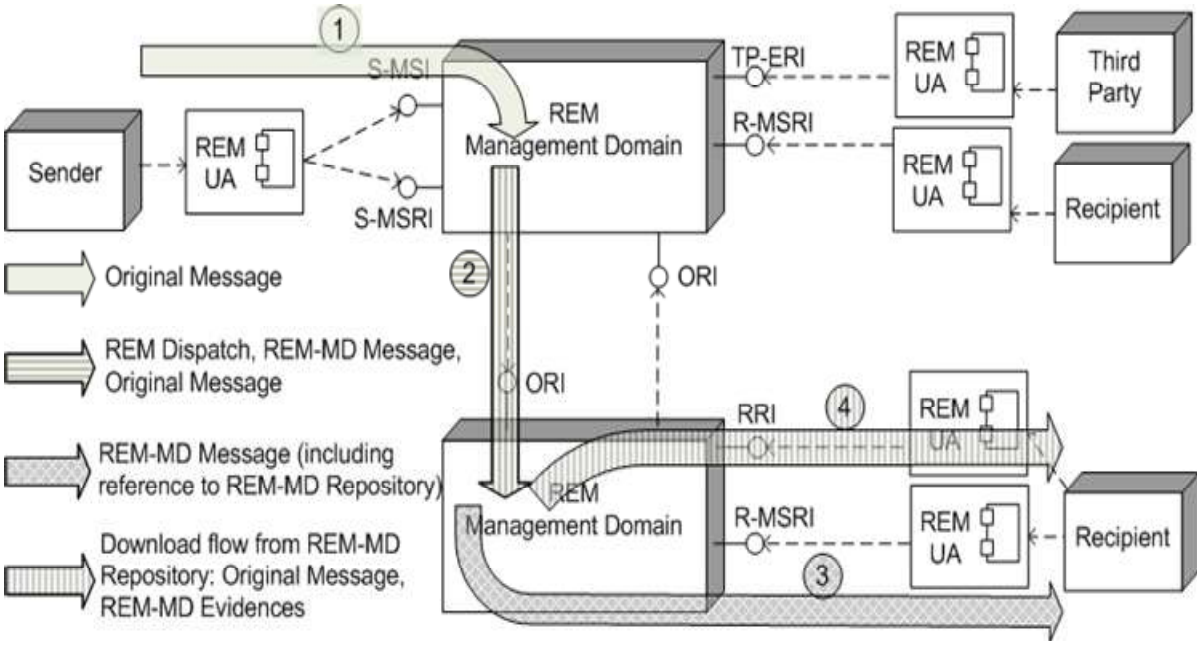


Figure 4: REM Store & Notify Logical Model - Recipient's REM-MD creating the REM-MD Message

In figure 4:

a) the REM Sender submits the Original Message addressed to the REM Recipient through the REM-MD Sender Message Submission Interface (flow 1 in figure 4);

b) the REM Sender's REM-MD forwards the REM Object to the REM Recipient's REM-MD through the REM Object Relay Interface (flow 2 in figure 4);

c) the REM Recipient's REM-MD:

1) stores the REM Object;

2) creates a REM-MD Message that contains a reference to the REM Object within the REM-MD Repository;

3) adds any appropriate REM-MD Evidence to the aforementioned REM-MD Message or stores the REM-MD Evidence in the REM-MD Repository; and

4) delivers this REM-MD Message to the REM Recipient, through REM-MD Recipient Message Store Retrieval Interface (flow 3 in figure 4);

d) the REM Recipient downloads the REM Object (and the REM-MD Evidence if they are stored in the REM-MD Repository) from the REM Recipient's REM-MD storage through the REM-MD Repository Retrieval Interface (flow 4 in figure 4).

NOTE 2: Depending on the implementation the REM Recipient **may** be also asked to accept/reject downloading the REM Object or the REM-MD Evidence stored in the REM-MD repository.

Hybrid implementations of this model **may** pass only some REM Object and/or REM-MD Evidence by reference, the rest being carried "in-band". For example: the data text can be carried in a REM-MD Message while attachments are referenced via a URL.

The data flow to the user is separated from the flow informing the REM Recipient of the presence of that data as illustrated above.

Signatures will be applied as specified in TS 102 640-2 [1].

4.3 Roles within a REM MD

As illustrated in figure 5, the logical model refines the REM-MD into separate roles. A role represents some externally visible aspect of the functionality provided within a REM-MD or related to it. An implementation component **may** carry out one or more roles in supporting REM Services, as described in this clause. In addition, the same role **may** be supported by several implementation components.

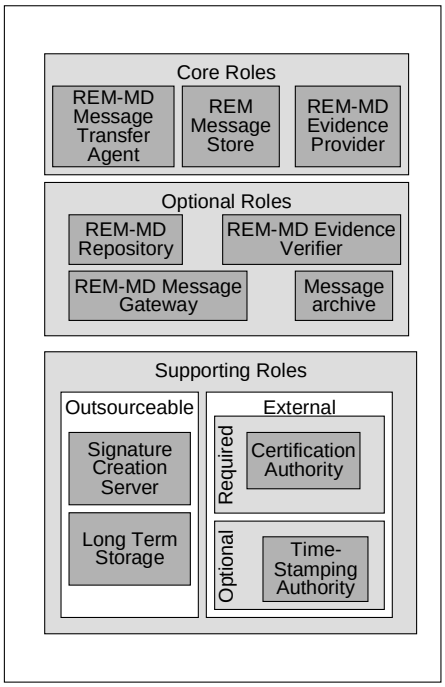


Figure 5: Roles within a REM-MD

The REM-MD **shall** include the following Core Roles: REM-MD Message Transfer Agent, REM Message Store, and REM-MD Evidence Provider. A REM Message Store is allocated to the REM Senders and REM Recipients and is securely accessible by REM Sender and REM Recipients respectively to retrieve REM Objects addressed to them.

The REM-MD **may** also include components supporting the following optional roles as described in figure 5: Message Archive, REM-MD Repository, REM-MD Evidence Verifier, and REM-MD Message Gateway.

A REM-MD Message Gateway supports the transfer of REM-MD Messages to and from external conventional e-mail (e.g. Internet) services to physical postal delivery services, as follows:

a) Gateway to physical mail: Where Original Messages are required by the REM Sender to be printed and forwarded by surface mail, or where this option is explicitly covered in the agreements between one REM-MD and its users. Please refer to clause 6 for further details on REM-MD Evidence. No general protocol is specified.

NOTE: Transfer of physical mail to a REM Recipient is outside the scope of the present document, since, when enacted, it is a mechanism purely internal to the specific REM-MD that **may**, therefore, implement it autonomously.

b) Gateway to ordinary email: REM MDs supporting this role **should** be able to exchange REM Objects, including REM Messages, in electronic form with non-REM service provider. However, a REM MD **may** just create and send REM-MD Evidence to provide certain types of evidence, for example: acceptance of the sent REM Object by the relevant REM-MD or notification that a REM Object is available for download from a REM-MD. Similarly, their needs might be satisfied by being able to exhibit trusted REM-MD Evidence that a certain REM Object, someone sent them, was actually received through their REM-MD at a certain time. Please refer to clause 6 for further details on REM-MD Evidence. Clause 5 of TS 102 640-2 [1] covers in detail these topics.

The REM-MD architecture **shall** include a Certification Authority supporting role. Additionally the following supporting roles **may** be used by the ones listed above in support of their functions as described in figure 5: Signature Creation Server, Time-Stamping Authority (TSA) and Long Term Storage.

Were entities and REM users are not equipped, or willing, to issue themselves signatures (e.g. on the REM-MD Evidence or the forwarded Original Message), they **may** take advantage of external Signature Creation Servers. The specific entity shall forward the to-be-signed object to the Signature Creation Server. Being this service provision most likely governed by a bilateral contractual relationship, the format and timing of the REM-MD Evidence is left up to these contracts, therefore no general protocol is specified.

Time Stamping Authority is an independent entity that issues Time Stamping Tokens of the submitted digests (protocols specified in RFC 3161 [i.4] **may** apply). Concerning reliable time provider, trusted time providers **may** be used by any entity issuing the above mentioned REM-MD Evidence (the NTP - RFC 1305 [i.5] - specifications **may** be used).

Among these supporting roles the CA and TSA roles **shall not** be in sourced. These services are intended to provide an additional layer of trust that only an entity third is able to give.

4.4 REM Administrative Viewpoint

From a policy and administrative viewpoint a set of REM-MDs **may** be grouped in Policy Domains as described in figure 6.

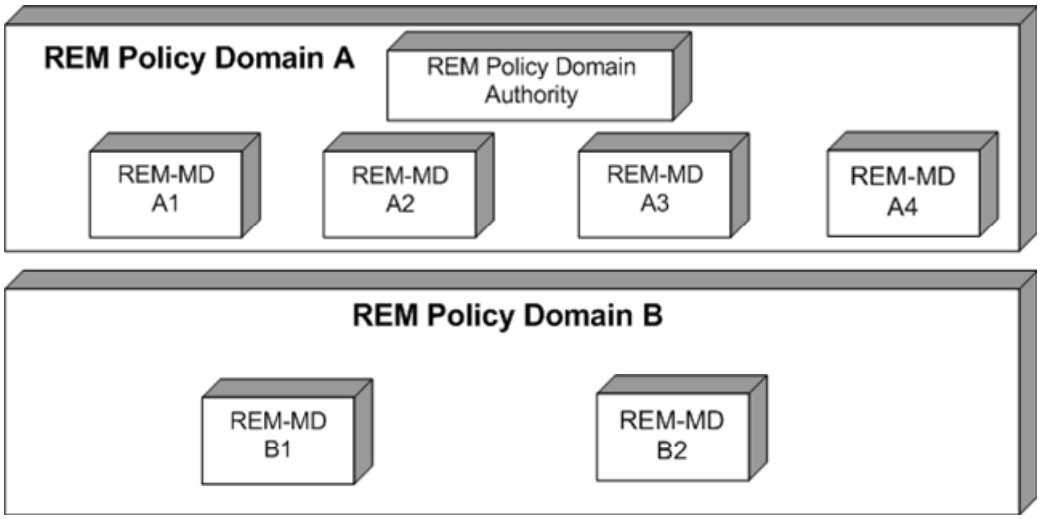


Figure 6: Logical grouping of REM-MDs in a policy domain

As defined in clause 3.1, a REM policy domain is any domain where a common set of rules (e.g. legal, company policy or agreement) is enforced for the provision of REM services. A REM Policy Domain **may** have an Authority supervising the application of the policy and, within one REM-PD, there **may** be one or more REM-MD that provide end users with the whole set of REM related services.

A REM-MD **may** belong to more than one REM-PD, provided that it complies with the rules of all of them. For example, a REM-MD set up in one country by a multinational company could be compliant to the sets of rules of both the relevant country and the multinational company.

REM-MDs that exchange REM-MD Envelopes (be they actually REM Dispatches or REM-MD Messages) trust each other by definition if they belong to the same REM-PD, especially if such REM-PD is governed by an Authority that ensures that all REM-MDs abide by common rules. The mechanism by which such REM-MDs abidance is made known to any interested entity depends on the single REM-PD rules, and **may** span from simple mechanisms to more complex ones, in fact, being all involved REM-MDs members of the same Domain, they accept such mechanism and are capable to cope with it.

On the other hand, when two REM-MDs belong to different REM-PDs there is the need for each of them to know whether their counterpart is considered as compliant with the rules of the purported REM-PD. This need would be hampered if each REM-PD acts, in practice, as an isolated domain that makes no information on their REM-MDs available from outside its own borders.

Without this information exchange the REM-MD Envelopes (REM Dispatches or REM-MD Messages) **may** still technically be transmitted, but their but their reliability cannot easily be judged lacking the endorsement provided by the formal recognition by the relevant Authorities.

It is therefore recommended that:

1) a REM-PD–internal mechanism to provide authorised entities with information on the REM-MDs governed by the Authority of the involved REM-PD, likely the same REM-PD these entities belong to; this mechanism **may** be freely chosen by each REM-PD if it is used only within the REM-PD at issue; access to the information **may** even be restrict to a limited number of entities, requiring their authentication;

2) a cross-REM-PD mechanism to allow the information in the item above to be accessed from one REM-PD to another; this mechanism, differently from the previous one, **shall** allow all the REM-MDs, that are supposed to reliably exchange REM-MD Envelopes, to ascertain the status of their counterparts in the relative pertaining REM-PDs.

While the present document gives no indication on the mechanism as in previous item 1, although it proposes the TSL as in TS 102 231 [i.10], it recommends adoption of the said TS 102 231 [i.10] at least as a mechanism as in item 2.

5 REM Interfaces

REM components, as described in clause 4.1, interact using the following interfaces:

1) REM-MD Sender Message Submission Interface: this interface is used by the user acting as a REM Sender to submit REM Objects to his REM-MD, for them to be forwarded to the REM Recipients. It is recommended that REM Object are submitted protected (e.g. by using SMTP with TLS/SSL). The user **may** authenticate using passwords if protected and only used with an authenticated server (e.g. using TLS/SSL).

2) REM-MD Sender/Recipient Message Store Retrieval Interfaces: this interface is used by REM Senders or REM Recipients to fetch REM Objects trough a reference to REM-MD Repository addressed to them. It is recommended that REM Objects are retrieved protected (e.g. using pop3, or imap with TLS/SSL). The user **may** authenticate using passwords if protected and only used with an authenticated server (e.g. using TLS/SSL).

3) REM-MD Repository Retrieval Interface: this interface is used in the Store and Notify Style of Operation by the REM Recipient for downloading REM Objects or REM-MD Evidence from a REM-MD Repository. It **may** also be used by REM Senders for downloading REM-MD Evidence. It is recommended that REM Objects or REM-MD Evidence are retrieved protected (e.g. using HTTP or FTP using a URL with TLS/SSL). The user **may** authenticate using passwords if protected and only used with an authenticated server (e.g. using TLS/SSL).

4) REM Object Relay Interface: the Relay interface allows REM Object and related REM-MD Evidence to be relayed between disparate REM-MDs. It is recommended that REM Object are relayed between REM-MDs using a recognised standard protocol which authenticates the origin of the REM Object (e.g. S/MIME over SMTP).

5) Non REM Relay Interface: this interface is provided to allow client-based REM Object retrieval and web-based REM Object retrieval. It is recommended that REM Object are relayed using a recognised standard protocol which authenticates the origin of the REM Object (e.g. S/MIME over SMTP).

6) REM-MD Third Party Evidence Retrieval Interface: this interface is provided to allow REM-MD Evidence and REM Object retrieval by users that are parties external to the usual message flow. These users might require access to REM-MD Evidence in some specific cases (i.e. a tribunal in case of dispute, or a third party nominated by the REM Sender or REM Recipient for receiving REM-MD Evidence on their behalf).

NOTE: The present document does not standardize this interface.

6 REM Events and REM-MD Evidence

6.1 Overview

In this clause the REM Events represented by REM-MD Evidence types are listed, along with a brief description of what event each REM-MD Evidence has the Purpose to state. Issued REM-MD Evidence can serve more purposes by including information related to more Events. The REM-MD Evidence topic is extensively addressed in TS 102 640-2 [1], clause 5.1 that covers also the REM-MD Evidence general structure and the content of each REM-MD Evidence type, as described in table 1.

Table 1: Event types and content of REM-MD Evidence

Event and REM-MD Evidence	REM-MD Evidence (TS 102 640-2 [1], clause 5.1)
6.2.1 Event A.1 - S-REM-MD Acceptance	5.1.1 SubmissionAcceptanceRejection
6.2.1 Event A.2 - S-REM-MD Rejection	
6.2.2 Event B.1 - R-REM-MD Acceptance	5.1.2 RelayToREMMDAcceptanceRejection
6.2.2 Event B.2 - R-REM-MD Rejection	
6.2.2 Event B.3 - Expiration of time to deliver to R-REM-MD	5.1.3 RelayToREMMDFailure
6.2.3 Event C.1 - REM Object Delivery	5.1.4 DeliveryNonDeliveryToRecipient
6.2.3 Event C.2 - Non delivery within a given retention period	
6.2.3 Event D.1 - REM-MD Message Delivery	
6.2.3 Event D.2 - Expiration of time to deliver	
6.2.3 Event E.1 - (REM-MD Repository) Download	5.1.5 DownloadNonDownloadByRecipient
6.2.3 Event E.2 - (REM-MD Repository) Expiration of time for download	
6.2.3 Event E.4 - (REM-MD Repository) Download by a REM Recipient's delegate	
6.2.3 Event F.1 - (mailbox) - Retrieval	5.1.6 RetrievalNonRetrievalByRecipient
6.2.3 Event F.2 - (mailbox) - Expiration of time for Retrieval	
6.2.3 Event F.3 - (mailbox) - Retrieval by a REM Recipient's delegate	
6.2.3 Event E.3 - Rejection of download by REM Recipient	5.1.7 AcceptanceRejectionByRecipient
6.2.4 Event H.1 - Successful forwarding for Ordinary e-mail	5.1.8 RelayToNonREMSystem
6.2.4 Event H.2 - Unsuccessful forwarding for Ordinary e-mail	
6.2.4 Event G.1 - Successful forwarding for Printing	
6.2.4 Event G.2 - Unsuccessful forwarding for Printing	
6.2.4 Event I.1 - E-mail message received from a regular e-mail system	5.1.9 ReceivedByNonREMSystem

A REM Object **may** be electronically signed by the REM Sender to provide the REM Recipient with information on the REM Object origin and authenticity. Similarly, each REM-MD Evidence **may** be signed. At least the REM Object AND/OR all of the REM-MD Evidence it carries **shall** be signed. The REM Recipient **may** deem this information as reliable if the certificate supporting the signature is issued by a Certification Authority that the REM Recipient acknowledges as trusted (see note) and, where required, if the signature is issued by means of a Secure Signature Creation Device with the meaning of article 2(6) of the Directive 1999/93/EC [i.1]. Other signature attributes cannot be automatically inferred as reliable, for example the signing time that derives from the REM Sender's system that is not per se a trusted entity.

NOTE: As an example, in the European Union, Certification Authorities issuing Qualified Certificates, as defined in the European Directive 1999/93/EC [i.1], article 2(10), are trusted since article 3(3) of the same Directive mandates that they are supervised in the EUMS they reside in.

It is assumed that the signature is at least an Advanced Electronic Signature (AdES) as defined in Directive 1999/93/EC [i.1] of the European Parliament and of the Council of 13 December 1999 on a Community framework for electronic signatures. Depending on the applicable legislation, this AdES **may** be supported with a QC and/or issued with a SSCD and, where required, if the signature is issued by means of a Secure Signature Creation Device.

6.2 Event Types and their Proof

In this clause the Events related to the basic REM functions are listed, logically grouped on the basis of what the related REM-MD Evidence types have the purpose to prove.

In order to facilitate interoperability and based on the outcomes of a survey performed among a large number of interviewees, the REM-MD Evidence type related to each event below is indicated as "M" (mandatory), "R" (recommended) or "O" (optional).

6.2.1 Events and REM-MD Evidence related to the REM Sender's REM-MD

A) Submission

1) Submission acceptance

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that a certain REM Object was successfully submitted, at the time indicated in the REM-MD Evidence, to the REM Sender's REM-MD by the REM Sender upon authentication by the REM Sender's REM-MD.
- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "M".

2) Submission non acceptance

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that a certain REM Object that was submitted, at the time indicated in the REM-MD Evidence, to the REM Sender's REM-MD by the REM Sender upon authentication by the REM-MD, was not accepted by the REM Sender's REM-MD.
- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "M".

6.2.2 Events and REM-MD Evidence related to the REM Recipient's REM-MD

B) Reception by the REM Recipient's REM-MD

1) REM Object acceptance by the REM Recipient's REM-MD

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that one REM Object sent by the REM Sender's REM-MD and successfully received by the REM Recipient's REM-MD, was accepted by the latter.
- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "R".

2) REM Object rejection by the REM Recipient's REM-MD

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that one REM Object sent by the REM Sender's REM-MD and successfully received by the REM Recipient's REM-MD, was rejected by the latter due to policy, formal or technical reasons.
- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "O".

3) Non delivery within a given time period of the REM Object to the REM Recipient's REM-MD

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that it was impossible to deliver within a given time period a REM Object to the REM Recipient's REM-MD due to technical errors and/or other problems.

NOTE: This **may** depend on:

a) it is impossible for the REM Sender's REM-MD to identify the REM Recipient's REM-MD;

b) the REM Recipient's REM-MD is unreachable;

c) the REM Recipient's REM-MD rejected the REM Object for any reason.

- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "R".

6.2.3 Events and REM-MD Evidence related to the REM Recipient

C) REM Object delivery

1) Delivery

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that the REM Object was delivered to the REM Recipient's mailbox at a specific time.

- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "M".

2) Non delivery within a given retention period

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: this REM-MD Evidence type has two purposes:

  a) to prove that the REM Object could not be delivered to the REM Recipient's mailbox within a given time period due to technical errors and/or other reasons;

  b) to indicate that no prove of delivery within a given period exists.

- The time limit is fixed by statutory or contractual rules, or it is pre-defined by the REM Sender.

NOTE 1: The REM-MD Evidence applies to the following two different events:

  i) the REM Recipient's REM-MD sends back to the REM Sender's REM-MD the REM-MD Evidence of delivery/non delivery, to be forwarded to the REM Sender, in this case this REM-MD Evidence is generated by the REM Recipient's REM-MD;

  ii) the REM Sender's REM-MD, after having received from the REM Recipient's REM-MD the REM-MD Evidence that it accepted the REM Object to be delivered to the REM Recipient's mailbox, does not receive within a given time period from the same REM-MD the REM-MD Evidence as in item C.1; in this case the REM Sender's REM-MD will create this REM-MD Evidence with a suitable reason code to indicate the event type.

- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "M".

D) REM-MD Message delivery

1) Delivery to the REM Recipient's mailbox of a reference to REM-MD Repository that a REM Object is available for downloading

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that the REM Recipient's REM-MD delivered to the REM Recipient's mailbox a reference to REM-MD Repository that a REM Object is ready to be downloaded from a REM-MD Repository.

- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "M".

2) Non delivery to the REM Recipient's mailbox within a given period of a REM-MD Message that a REM Object is stored and available to be downloaded

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: this REM-MD Evidence type has two purposes:

  a) to prove that the REM MD Message could not be delivered to the REM Recipient's mailbox within a given time period due to technical errors and/or other reasons;

  b) to indicate that no prove of delivery within a given period exists.

- The time limit is fixed by statutory or contractual rules, or it is pre-defined by the REM Sender.

NOTE 2: The REM-MD Evidence applies to the following two different events:

  i) the REM Recipient's REM-MD sends back to the REM Sender's REM-MD the REM-MD Evidence of delivery/non delivery, to be forwarded to the REM Sender, in this case this REM-MD Evidence is generated by the REM Recipient's REM-MD;

  ii) the REM Sender's REM-MD, after having received from the REM Recipient's REM-MD the REM-MD Evidence that it accepted the REM-MD Message to be delivered, does not receive within a given time period from the same REM-MD the REM-MD Evidence as in item D.1.; in this case the REM Sender's REM-MD will create this REM-MD Evidence with a suitable reason code to indicate the event type.

- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "M".

E) REM Object download

1) Download

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that the REM Object was downloaded by the REM Recipient or by a delegate at a specific time.
- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "M".

2) Non download within a given retention period (see also item 14)

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that the REM Object was not downloaded within a given period from the REM-MD Repository under the responsibility of the REM Recipient's REM-MD due to technical errors and/or other reasons.
- The time limit is fixed by statutory or contractual rules, or it is pre-defined by the REM Sender.
- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "M".

3) Rejection by the REM Recipient of the REM Object to be downloaded

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that the REM Object to be downloaded was rejected by the REM Recipient.
- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "R".

4) Download by an entity delegated by the REM Recipient

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that the REM Object was downloaded by some entity delegated by the REM Recipient.
- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "O".

F) Content retrieval

1) Retrieval

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that the REM Object present in the REM Recipient's mailbox was retrieved by the REM Recipient.

NOTE 3: This REM-MD Evidence type is referred to the moment the REM Recipient actually accesses its mailbox with a mail client, be it an asynchronous client (like Outlook, Thunderbird, etc.) or a webmail client.

- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "O".

2) Non retrieval within a given period

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that the REM Object present in the REM Recipient's mailbox was not retrieved by the REM Recipient's mail client within a given period.
- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "O".

3) REM Object retrieval by an entity delegated by the REM Recipient

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that the REM Object was retrieved by some entity delegated by the REM Recipient.
- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "O".

6.2.4 Events and REM-MD Evidence related to connections with outside the REM-MD

G) Printing

1) The Original Message was successfully submitted to a printing system to be subsequently sent via physical registered mail

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that a certain Original Message was, on behalf of the REM Sender's or REM Recipient's REM-MD, successfully printed to be forwarded via physical registered mail.

NOTE 1: The Original Message **may** also be printed to be forwarded through physical registered mail on behalf of the REM Sender's or REM Recipient's REM-MD, in case the Original Message cannot be delivered into the REM Recipient's mailbox only if a specific statutory or contractual requirement exists to enact such forwarding.

- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "O".

2) The submission to a printing system of the Original Message to be subsequently sent via physical registered mail was unsuccessful

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that the REM Sender's or REM Recipient's REM-MD was unable to submit the Original Message to a printing system to subsequently forward it to physical registered mail.

NOTE 2: See note in previous REM-MD Evidence.

- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "O".

H) Forward to regular e-mail

1) The REM Object was successfully forwarded to a regular e-mail service

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that a certain REM Object was successfully forwarded on behalf of the REM Sender's or of the REM Recipient's REM-MD to a regular e-mail service.

NOTE 3: Depending on the statutory or contractual agreements, the REM Sender's REM-MD or the REM Recipient's REM-MD **may** forward a REM Object to ordinary e-mail also if it is not able to forward it to the REM Recipient's REM-MD via REM.

- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "O".

2) The REM Object forwarding to regular e-mail was unsuccessful

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that the REM Sender's or REM Recipient's REM-MD was not able to forward a REM Object to a regular e-mail service.

- REM-MD Evidence Optionality: "O".

I) Non REM origin

1) E-mail message was successfully received from a regular e-mail system

- Purpose of the related REM-MD Evidence: to prove that a certain email was not received from a REM-MD but from an ordinary e-mail server, therefore all information related to its sending, like the REM Sender's address and the sending time, cannot be trusted per se.

7 REM Trust Building

REM-MDs belonging to different REM-PDs may need to reliably implement a seamless mutual exchange of REM-MD Envelopes (be they actually REM Dispatches or REM-MD Messages). In this case, in addition to the interoperability related technicalities, it is indispensible, in order to achieve the desired reliability, that all the interested entities (i.e. Relying Parties) have access to the information on the abidance of the involved REM-MDs by the respective REM-PD rules. This access is required to be possible independently from what REM-PD the enquiring Relying Parties belong to. However, in a more restrictive implementation only a limited number of REM-PDs can agree to share this information type, thus not making it publicly open to anyone.

Apart from the latest case, where the restricted number of entities (i.e. REM-PDs) can agree on a bespoke solution, it is advisable that the information exchange mechanism **is** as open as possible, so that, in subsequent times, Relying Parties belonging to additional REM-PDs can access the information at issue.

The recommended common mechanism is the Trust-service Status List (TSL) specified in the TS 102 231 [i.10].

NOTE: It is worth mentioning that TSL is being adopted in the European Union to share information on which Certification Service Providers - CSP - are reported as abiding by the regulation of the respective EU Member States - EUMS - on issuing ad managing Qualified Certificates.

In the following clauses different implementation types are described, where each REM-PD Authority that governs one REM-PD assesses the compliance of the REM-MDs, belonging to the REM-PD it governs, with the rules established for that REM-PD.

All the following implementation types do not intend to specify legal liabilities that are left to the applicable provisions.

7.1 Closed REM-PD

In one closed REM-PD, i.e. that envisages no interaction with other REM-PDs, any mechanism **may** be implemented to provide REM-PD wide accessibility to the REM-MD status information.

Where the TSL is used to this purpose it would list the related REM-MD, specifying, as indicated in TS 102 231 [i.10], both their current status and, optionally, their status history. Any entity belonging to the same REM-PD would access the TSL and verify its authenticity as provided for by the REM-PD rules. In this TSL, the signing public key of each REM-MD, or preferably its corresponding certificates, would be published so that any relying party would be able to use it to verify their signature on each REM-MD Envelope they issue. Where applicable, the history of the REM-MDs' status (when it was initially approved, when, possibly, such approval was revoked and when was subsequently reinstated) could be also found in the TSL, allowing users to ascertain the reliability in the past of a specific REM-MD Envelope. The following provisions apply.

a) The signature **should** be of the C/XAdES-T type as specified in TS 101 733 [i.14] and TS 101 903 [i.15]. No other extended signature forms are deemed necessary from the TSL verification standpoint.

b) The TSL **should** be reissued at regular intervals to avoid the risk that two valid TSLs exist at the same time. A risk would in fact arise if users download one TSL soon after its issue time, then cache it and refer only to the cached copy up to the time specified in the "Next update" field (TS 102 231 [i.10], clause 5.3.15), without checking at every verification if a new TSL has been issued in the meantime. Should instead a new TSL be issued much ahead of the time specified in the "Next update" field, there would be two, or even more, non expired TSLs available, with negative consequences. Such overlap might instead be acceptable if it is just of few minutes.

c) The TSL issue interval should not be longer than few months, depending on the volatility of the governed REM-MDs, to match the following requirements:

   1) timely updating the related REM-MDs status information;

   2) ensuring that the TSL signing certificate does not expire between two subsequent TSLs. The Authority's key pair and, where applicable, the related certificate **should** in fact be updated in advance of at least two TSL issuing intervals before the certificate expiration date.

d) The TSL signing public key **should** be made available to the interested entities through secure and reliable means, the choice of which is left up to the REM-PD governing Authority. One reliable means could for example be to publish its digest in an Official Journal.

e) One REM-PD that has no interest to being interoperable with other REM-PDs may adopt other technical mechanisms form the TSL, but it should however enforce the above specified organisational provisions.

7.2 Interoperable REM-PDs TSL - No Root TSL

Version 2 and subsequent ones of TS 102 231 [i.10] make it possible to point from the TSL issued by one REM-PD Authority to the TSLs published by other REM-PD Authorities. Optionally one REM-PD Authority **may** implement a mechanism different from the TSL to point to other REM-PDs TSLs, but the at least the TrST based mechanism to go back to the relevant TSL-based information or to any equivalent information **shall** be implemented to ensure interoperability.

If a REM-PD authority makes use of TSL to point to other TSLs issued by different Authorities, each TSL issuer **shall** implement what is specified in clause 7.1 where, to ensure interoperability, in provisions a), b), d), the "**should**" keyword is to be changed in "**shall**".

Additionally what is hereinafter specified also applies.

In the case addressed by this clause, each REM-PD Authority, depending on the REM-PD rules, has the right to recognise a number of other REM-PDs and to specify their recognition status in the TSL it issues and maintains.

Each TSL issuer **shall** collect in a reliable way the information, to be placed in its TSL, about the "external TSLs" whereabouts (i.e. URL) and digital identity (e.g. the signer's certificate) through which the related TSLs can be accessed and its integrity and authenticity can be verified.

One TSL issuer **may** act in one of the following two ways:

1) it **may** list the recognised external REM-PDs along with the "List of Trust Service Providers" detailed in clause 5.3.17 of the TS 102 231 [i.10];

2) it **may** implement a tuple of what can be called a "Base TSL", of type "Generic", and a "Bridge TSL", of Type "Schemes", (as defined in clause 5.3.3 "TSL type" of TS 102 231 [i.10]);

3) the "Base TSL" would only list REM-MDs belonging to the REM-PD at issue and would point, by means of the field "Pointers to other TSLs" (TS 102 231 [i.10], clause 5.3.13), to the "Bridge TSL" that would list only external REM-PDs in its "List of Trust Service Providers" section.

It is to be remarked that the pointed-to REM-PDs **may** or **may not** reciprocate the recognition.

7.2.1 Interoperable REM-PDs TSL - No Root TSL: an example

Figure 7 presents a possible usage of TSL for interoperable REM-PDs with no Root TSL. Different types of TSLs are represented, with their relationships, in detail:

1) REM-PD 1 implements one "Base TSL - Bridge TSL" mechanism; its Base TSL points to the Bridge TSL that in turn points to the TSLs of the other domains recognised by the governing Authority;

2) REM-PD 2 implements a TSL of Type "Generic" where REM-MDs internal to the REM-PD are listed along with the external REM-PDs recognised by the REM-PD 2 Authority; it can be noticed that in this example REM-PD 2 does not recognise REM-PD 1, while it recognises REM-PDs 3 and 4;

3) REM-PD 3 implements a "Generic" TSL; it recognises REM-PDs 1 and 4, but not REM-PD 2;

4) REM-PD 4 implements one "Base TSL - Bridge TSL" mechanism; its Bridge TSL points to the TSLs of REM-PDs 1 and 3, but not to that of REM-PD 2.

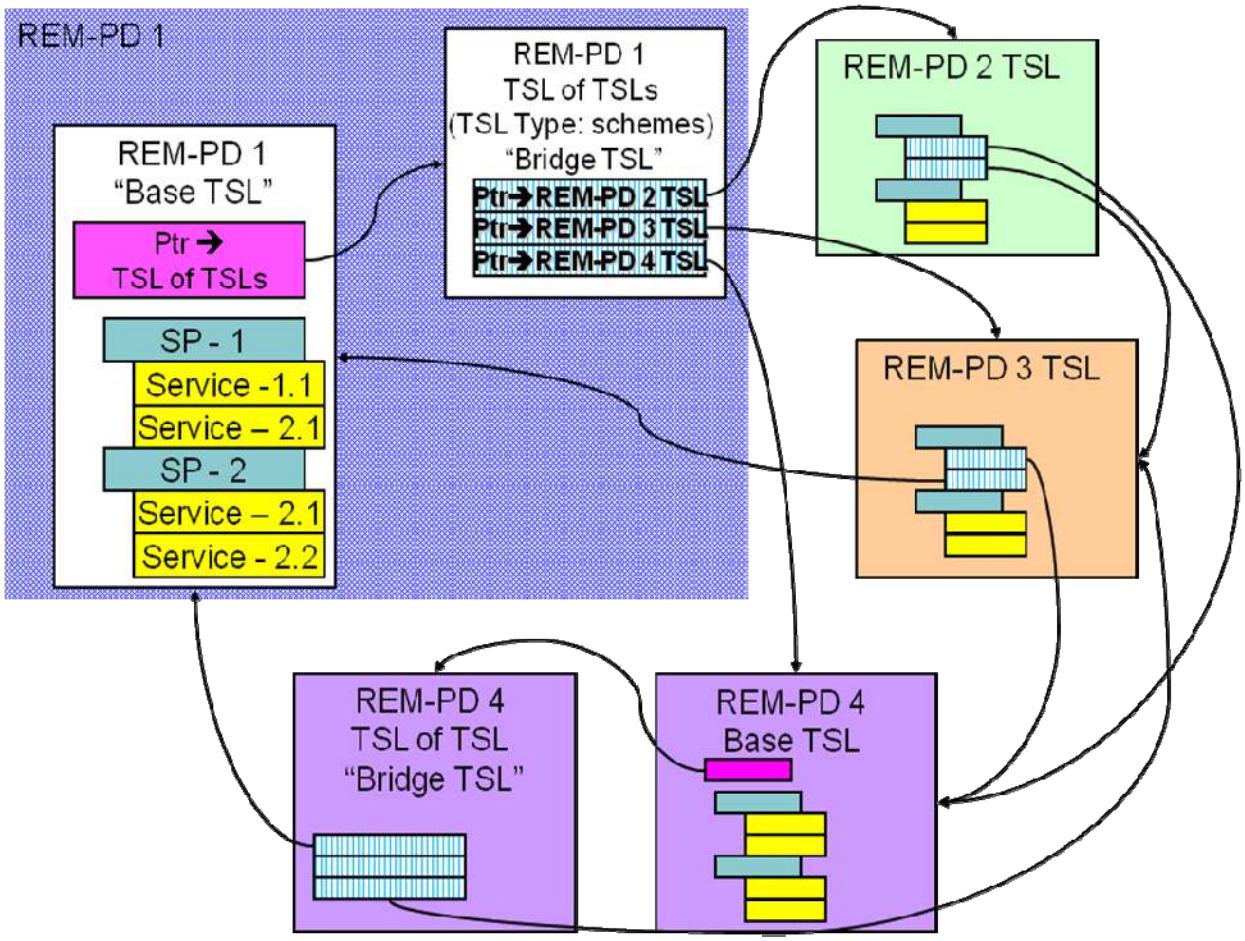


Figure 7

7.3 Interoperable REM-PDs TSL - Root TSL

What is specified in clause 7.1 applies. To ensure interoperability in provisions a), b), d), the "**should**" keyword is to be changed to "**shall**".

Additionally what is hereinafter specified also applies.

In this TSL implementation a Higher Authority assesses the abidance by the common rules only of the directly governed REM-PDs that will in turn be responsible to assess the abidance by the respective REM-PD rules of each REM-MD they govern.

This higher Authority is responsible to issue and maintain a Root TSL, of Type "Schemes", where the "lower level" REM-PDs, that in turn issue their own TSLs, are listed as TSPs. In the Root TSL each TSL entry related to one of these "lower level" REM-PD points to the TSL issued by the relevant governing Authority as well as the digital identity (e.g. the signer's certificate) with which the related TSLs integrity and authenticity can be verified. Likewise, all subject TSLs point to the Root TSL.

In this case this Higher Authority **shall** be responsible to collect in a reliable way the above mentioned information on the ""lower level TSLs" URL and digital identity.

7.3.1 Interoperable REM-PDs TSL - Root TSL: an example

Figure 8 presents a possible usage of TSL for interoperable REM-PDs with Root TSL.

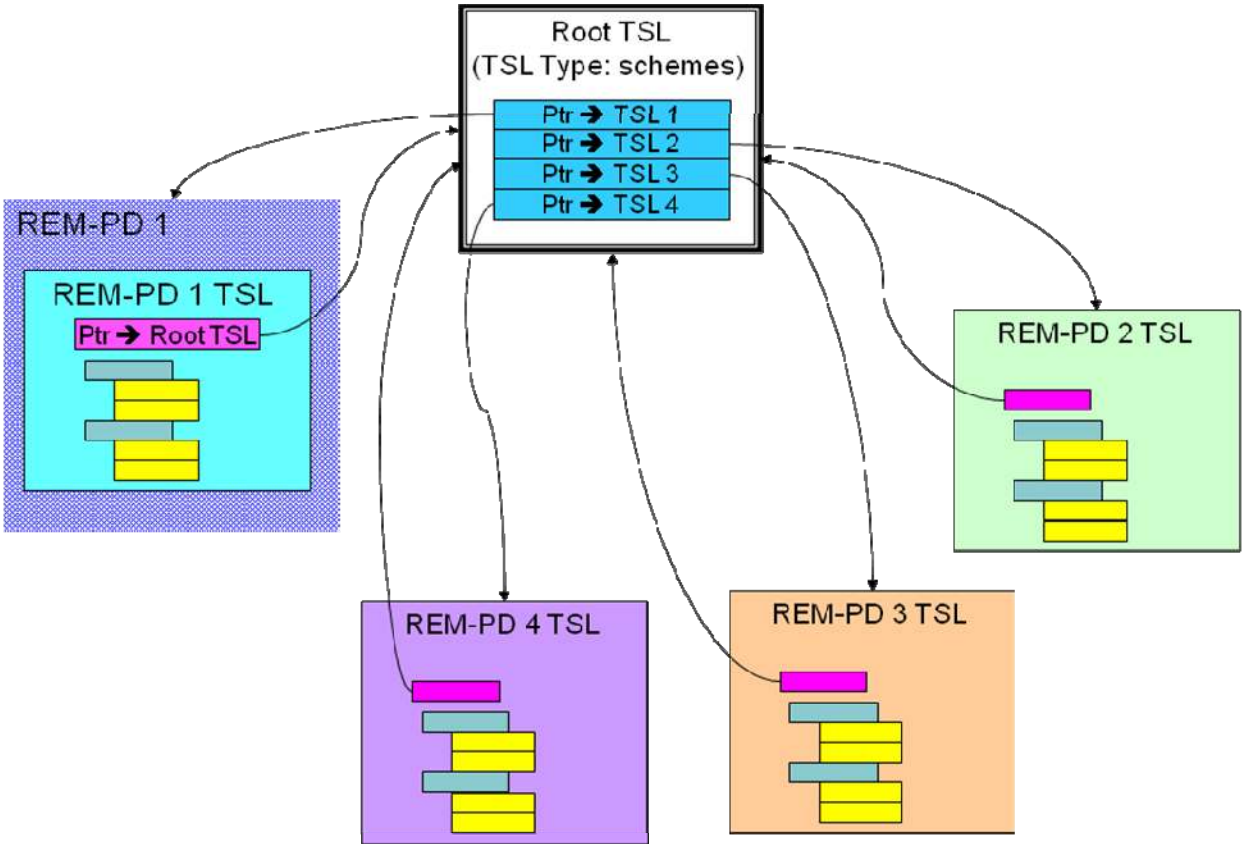


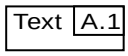
Figure 8

Annex A (informative): REM Events and Actions flows

Figure A.1 describes the sequence of actions performed by the involved entities (from the REM Sender up to the REM Recipient or to external entities, like regular e-mail server or printer server) and of the related events that lead to issuance and delivery of REM-MD Evidence. Event types are not indicated: they are detailed in clause 6.2.

1) Actions - Every action, to each of which one row is dedicated, is indicated in the column of the entity that performs it. From each action, arrows point to the entities the same action is directed to or to the events described in the related REM-MD Evidence, as specified in clause 6.2. These events are represented with boxes having this appearance: 

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2) Events - Events are represented with boxes having the following appearance: 

where the text describes the related event, as indicated in clause 6.2, and the small box inside refers to the event type as numbered in the same clause 6.2. Boxes related to successful events have a white background, those referring to unsuccessful ones have a background that prints in gray.

3) Junctions, i.e. where one action **may** produce more than one event, or one event is followed by more other events that can occur alternatively, are represented with a circle ○. Where applicable, black circles with white numbers inside indicate the sequence with which the events occur.

4) The symbol  indicates the entity to which an REM-MD Evidence, consequent to one event, is delivered. Connections to this symbol are in dotted arrows.

One REM-MD Message **may** refer to another REM-MD Message referring in turn to the final Original Message to be downloaded, therefore REM-MD Message Delivery (Action No 5) and REM Object download (Action No 6) can be iterated.

NOTE: Due to space restrictions the terms defined in clause 3.1 are shortened also by removing terms like REM and REM-MD where necessary.

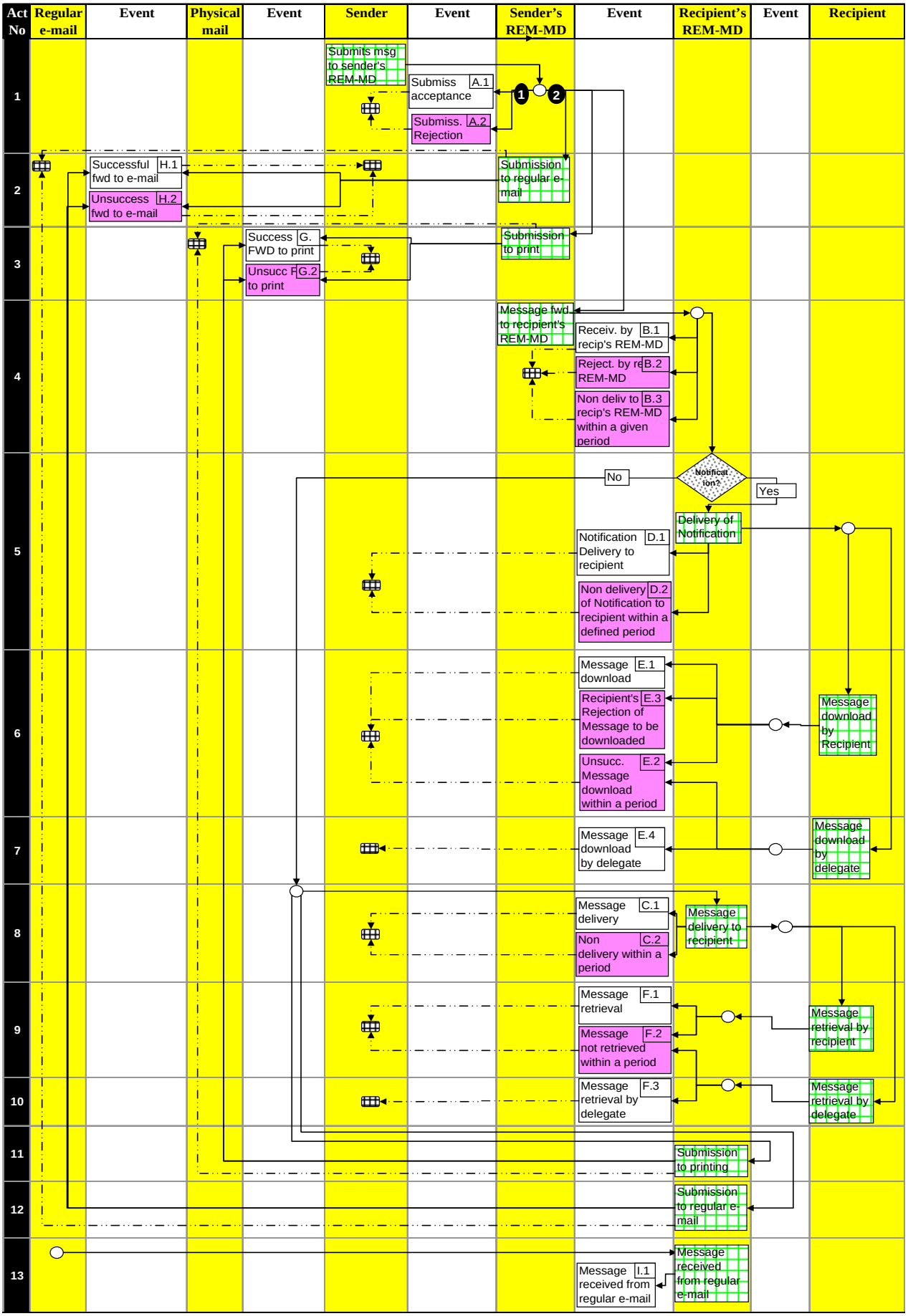


Figure A.1: Actions sequence

Figure A.2 specifies the sequence of the events performed when REM Object flow from one end (namely the REM Sender) to another end that can be the REM Recipient or provider of ordinary e-mail services or of printing services.

1) Events - Events are represented with boxes having the following appearance: A.1 Text where the text describes the related event and the small box inside refers to the event number as in the following clauses. Boxes related to successful events have a white background.

   Boxes referring to unsuccessful ones have a background that prints in gray.

   The box related to a regular e-mail that is received by the REM Recipient's REM-MD has a hatched background.

2) One REM-MD Message **may** refer to another REM-MD Message referring in turn to the final Original Message to be downloaded, therefore REM-MD Message Delivery (Event D.1) and REM Object download (Event E.4) can be iterated.

3) Events related to servers external to the REM lie on a light gray background.

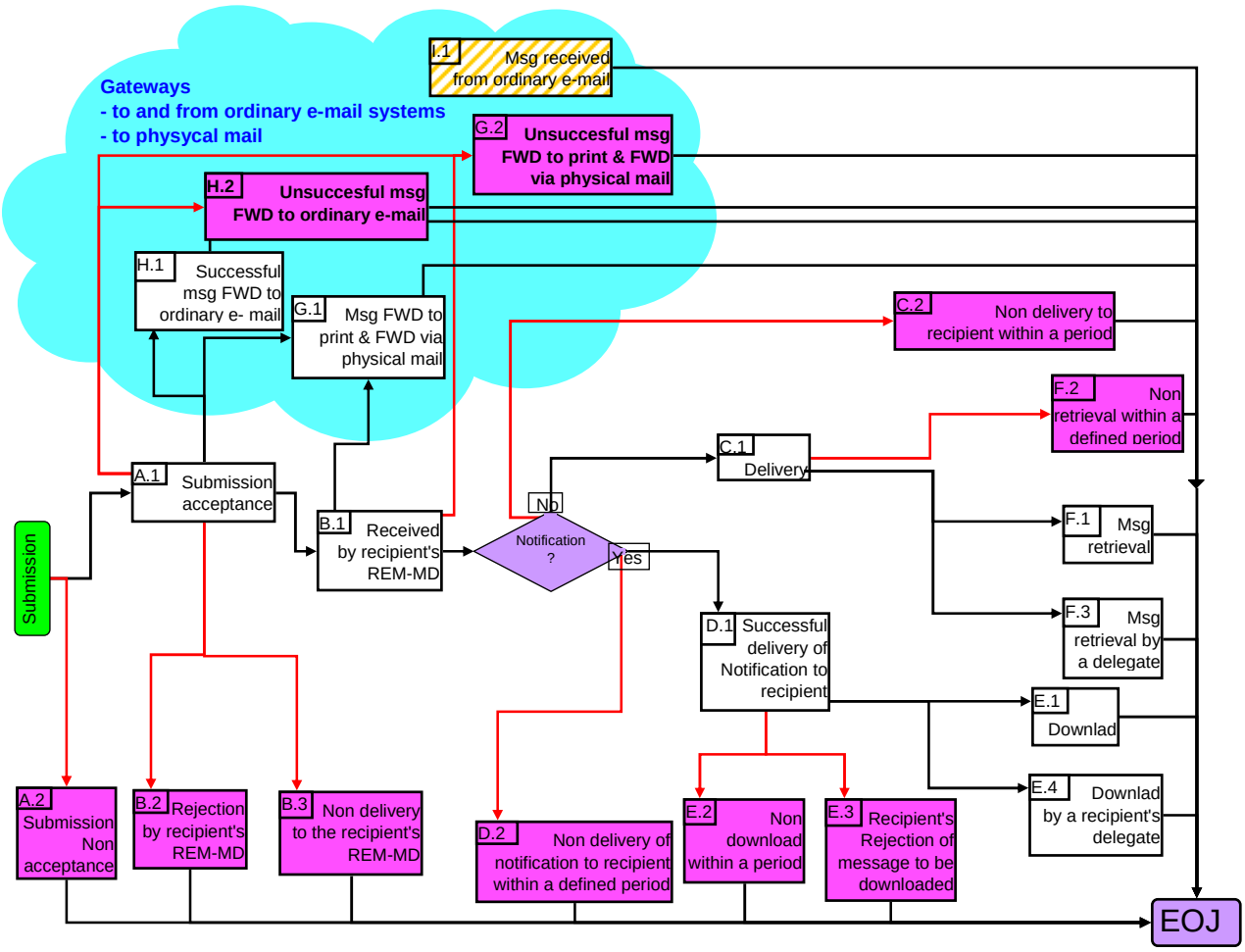


Figure A.2: REM Events flow

Annex B (informative): Bibliography

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- IETF RFC 2822: "Internet Message Format".

History

Document history		
V1.1.1	October 2008	Publication
V2.1.1	January 2010	Publication
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